

Here's the full family curation for **sweetness / sweet / sweeten / sweetened / sweetener**, anchored to the passage phrase **"a little sweetness in people's lives."** This is a rich family because it moves from **sugary taste → pleasant smell/sound/personality → emotional tenderness → pleasant experiences**, while **sweeten** develops both literal and figurative "make more attractive/better" senses. The full **MCQ-ready master list** is included.

SWEET / SWEETNESS / SWEETEN / SWEETENER

1. Passage anchor

> "I hope it will also be a way to create comfort, celebration, and a little **sweetness** in people's lives."

Passage meaning

sweetness = pleasantness, warmth, happiness, or something emotionally delightful

甜蜜；溫馨；美好

Here, **sweetness** is figurative. The speaker means the dessert business could bring small moments of happiness and warmth into people's lives.

Practice

1. Small celebrations can bring a little **sweetness** into everyday life.

小小的慶祝可以為日常生活帶來一些**甜蜜與美好**。

2. Her kindness added a sense of **sweetness** to the occasion.

她的善意為這個場合增添了一份**溫馨**。

Core meanings of SWEET

2. sweet — sugary taste

= tasting like sugar, honey, fruit, etc.

甜的

Examples

1. The cake is too **sweet** for me.

這個蛋糕對我來說太**甜**了。

2. These strawberries are naturally **sweet**.

這些士多啤梨天然就很**甜**。

This is the central literal sense.

3. sweet food

= food containing or tasting strongly of sugar

甜食；甜的食物

Examples

1. I try not to eat too much **sweet food**.
我盡量不吃太多**甜食**。
2. She prefers **sweet dishes** to savory ones.
比起鹹食，她更喜歡**甜味菜式**。

Noun: sweet food

4. sweet — small sweet food / candy

Especially BrE:

= small piece of sugary confectionery

糖果

Examples

1. The child asked for a **sweet**.
那個孩子想要一顆**糖果**。
2. Don't eat too many **sweets** before dinner.
晚餐前不要吃太多**糖果**。

In AmE, **candy** is generally more common.

5. sweets — sweet foods

= sugary foods collectively

甜食；糖果

Examples

1. She has always loved **sweets**.

她一直很喜歡**甜食**。

2. The shop sells cakes, biscuits, and other **sweets**.

這家店售賣蛋糕、餅乾和其他**甜食**。

Dessert course

6. sweet — dessert

Especially BrE:

= sweet course eaten at the end of a meal

甜品；餐後甜點

Examples

1. What would you like for **sweet**?

你餐後想吃甚麼**甜品**？

2. We had fruit for **sweet**.

我們餐後吃水果作為**甜點**。

More commonly **dessert** in many contexts.

Pleasant smell

7. sweet — pleasant-smelling

= having a pleasant, often floral or fresh smell

芳香的；香甜的

Examples

1. The flowers have a **sweet smell**.

這些花有一股**芳香**。

2. A **sweet scent** filled the room.

房間裡充滿一股**香甜的氣味**。

Pleasant sound / voice

8. sweet — pleasant to hear

= gentle, clear, melodious, or pleasing in sound

悅耳的；甜美的

Examples

1. She has a **sweet voice**.

她有一把**甜美悅耳的聲音**。

2. We heard the **sweet sound** of birds singing.

我們聽到鳥兒**悅耳的歌聲**。

Kind / lovable personality

9. sweet — kind and pleasant

= kind, gentle, thoughtful, or lovable

親切的；體貼的；可愛的

Examples

1. That was very **sweet of you**.

你這樣做真的很**貼心**。

2. She is a very **sweet person**.

她是一個非常**親切可愛的人**。

Major figurative everyday sense.

10. sweet of someone

= kind or thoughtful of someone

某人很貼心 / 很體貼

Examples

1. It was **sweet of him** to remember my birthday.

他記得我的生日，真的很**貼心**。

2. That's **sweet** of you to say.

你這樣說真是**很體貼**。

Romantic / affectionate

11. sweet — affectionate / romantic

= expressing affection, tenderness, or romantic warmth

甜蜜的；溫柔的

Examples

1. He wrote her a **sweet message**.

他寫了一段很**甜蜜的**訊息**給**她。

2. They shared a **sweet moment** together.

他們一起度過了一個**溫馨甜蜜的**時刻**。**

Cute / charming

12. sweet — charming or endearing

= pleasantly attractive in an innocent, gentle, or cute way

可愛的；討人喜歡的

Examples

1. What a **sweet little dog**!

多麼**可愛**的小狗**！**

2. That is such a **sweet picture**.

那張照片真的很**溫馨可愛**。

Pleasant / satisfying situation

13. sweet — pleasant or satisfying

Informal:

= particularly good, satisfying, enjoyable, or desirable

****美好的；令人滿意的；爽快的****

Examples

1. Victory felt especially ****sweet**** after years of disappointment.

經歷多年失望後，這次勝利顯得格外****美好 / 痛快****。

2. It was a ****sweet moment**** for the whole team.

那是整個團隊一個非常****美好的時刻****。

14. sweet victory / success

= success that feels especially satisfying

****甜美的 / 令人痛快的勝利或成功****

Examples

1. Revenge made the victory even ****sweeter****.

復仇令這次勝利感覺更加****痛快****。

2. After years of work, success was ****sweet****.

多年努力後，成功的滋味格外****美好****。

Informal approval

15. sweet! — excellent / great

Informal:

= great; excellent; pleasing

****太好了！；正！；很棒！****

Examples

1. "We got front-row seats." *****Sweet!*****

「我們拿到第一排座位了。」**「**太棒了！**」**

2. That new setup is ****sweet****.

那套新設備真的****很棒****。

Register-sensitive.

No salt / fresh water

16. sweet — not salty

In established uses:

= containing little or no salt

淡的；非鹹水的

sweet water / sweet water historically/technically

淡水

This use is much less common than **fresh water** in everyday English.

Petroleum / chemistry

17. sweet — low in sulfur

Technical:

= containing relatively little sulfur or sulfur compounds

低硫的

Examples

1. The refinery processes **sweet crude oil**.

煉油廠處理**低硫原油**。

2. **Sweet crude** generally contains less sulfur than sour crude.

低硫原油通常比高硫原油含較少硫。

Established specialist sense.

SWEETNESS

18. sweetness — sweet taste

= quality of tasting sweet

****甜味；甜度****

Examples

1. The fruit has a natural ****sweetness****.
這種水果有天然的****甜味****。
2. Reduce the ****sweetness**** by using less sugar.
少放一點糖來降低****甜度****。

19. sweetness — pleasant nature / kindness

= quality of being gentle, lovable, kind, or pleasant
****溫柔；親切；可愛****

Examples

1. Everyone noticed the ****sweetness**** of her personality.
大家都注意到她個性中的****溫柔親切****。
2. There was real ****sweetness**** in the way he cared for his family.
他照顧家人的方式帶著真正的****溫情****。

20. sweetness — emotional pleasantness

= pleasant, tender, comforting, or happy quality in an experience
****甜蜜；溫馨；美好****

This is the exact passage branch.

Examples

1. The story contains both sadness and ****sweetness****.
故事既有悲傷，也有****溫馨甜蜜****。
2. The celebration added some ****sweetness**** to an ordinary day.
這場慶祝為平凡的一天增添了一些****美好與甜蜜****。

SWEETEN

21. sweeten — make sweeter in taste

= add sugar, honey, sweetener, etc. to make something taste sweeter

****使變甜；加糖****

Examples

1. She ****sweetened the tea**** with honey.
她用蜂蜜把茶****調甜****。
2. The yogurt is lightly ****sweetened****.
這款乳酪經過輕微****加糖調甜****。

Central verb sense.

22. sweeten — become sweeter

= develop a sweeter taste

****變甜****

Examples

1. The fruit ****sweetens**** as it ripens.
水果成熟時會****變甜****。
2. The sauce ****sweetened**** as it reduced.
醬汁煮濃後味道****變得更甜****。

Improve / make more attractive

23. sweeten — make an offer/deal more attractive

= add an extra benefit so that an offer, deal, proposal, etc. becomes more appealing

****增加好處；提高吸引力；加碼****

Examples

1. They ****sweetened the offer**** with a signing bonus.
他們加入簽約獎金來****提高這項條件的吸引力****。
2. The seller ****sweetened the deal**** by including free delivery.
賣方加入免費送貨來****加碼這筆交易****。

Very high-value figurative sense.

24. sweeten the deal

= make an agreement more attractive by adding advantages

增加優惠條件；讓交易更吸引

Examples

1. They added a discount to **sweeten the deal**.

他們加入折扣來**增加這筆交易的吸引力**。

2. Free installation helped **sweeten the deal**.

免費安裝讓這個方案變得**更吸引**。

Make situation more pleasant

25. sweeten — make an experience less unpleasant

= make a situation more pleasant or easier to accept

改善；使較容易接受

Examples

1. A small bonus helped **sweeten the disappointment**.

一筆小獎金多少**減輕了失望感**。

2. The good news **sweetened** an otherwise difficult day.

這個好消息令原本艱難的一天**多了一點美好**。

SWEETENED

26. sweetened — containing added sweetener

= made sweeter by adding sugar or another sweetener

加糖的；加甜味劑的

Examples

1. I prefer unsweetened milk to **sweetened milk**.

比起**加糖牛奶**，我更喜歡無糖牛奶。

2. The drink is artificially **sweetened**.

這種飲品使用人工甜味劑**調甜**。

27. unsweetened

= having no sugar or sweetener added

無加糖的；無添加甜味劑的

Examples

1. Use **unsweetened cocoa powder**.

使用**無糖可可粉**。

2. She drinks **unsweetened tea**.

她喝**無糖茶**。

High-value opposite family member.

SWEETENER

28. sweetener — substance used to make food/drink sweet

= sugar or another substance added to create sweetness

甜味劑；甜味料

Examples

1. Honey can be used as a natural **sweetener**.

蜂蜜可以作為天然**甜味劑**。

2. The drink contains an artificial **sweetener**.

這種飲品含有人工**甜味劑**。

29. artificial sweetener

= non-sugar substance used to provide sweet taste

人工甜味劑；代糖

Examples

1. Some drinks contain **artificial sweeteners**.
有些飲品含有**人工甜味劑**。
2. She uses an **artificial sweetener** instead of sugar.
她使用**代糖**而不是砂糖。

30. natural sweetener

= naturally derived substance used to sweeten food or drink
天然甜味劑

Examples

1. Honey is often used as a **natural sweetener**.
蜂蜜常被用作**天然甜味劑**。
2. The recipe uses fruit as a **natural sweetener**.
這個食譜使用水果作為**天然甜味來源**。

Informal figurative noun: sweetener

31. sweetener — extra incentive

Especially BrE/business:

= extra benefit added to make a deal, offer, or arrangement more attractive
額外優惠；誘因；加碼條件

Examples

1. The company added a cash **sweetener** to the offer.
公司在方案中加入現金**額外優惠**。
2. Free delivery was included as a **sweetener**.
免費送貨被加入作為一項**加碼誘因**。

This directly parallels **sweeten the deal**.

SWEETLY

32. sweetly — pleasantly / gently

= in a pleasant, gentle, or charming way

****甜美地；溫柔地****

Examples

1. She smiled ****sweetly****.
她****甜甜地 / 溫柔地****笑了。
2. The birds sang ****sweetly****.
鳥兒****悅耳地****歌唱。

SWEET-TOOTH FAMILY

33. sweet tooth

= strong liking for sweet foods

****嗜甜；愛吃甜食****

Examples

1. I have a ****sweet tooth****.
我很****愛吃甜食****。
2. This bakery is perfect for anyone with a ****sweet tooth****.
這家烘焙店很適合任何****嗜甜的人****。

Very relevant to the passage domain.

Sweet spot

34. sweet spot — ideal point / optimum

= position, level, combination, or condition that gives the best result

****最佳點；理想平衡點****

Examples

1. We need to find the **sweet spot** between price and quality.

我們需要找出價格與品質之間的**最佳平衡點**。

2. The oven temperature has a **sweet spot** for these cookies.

烤這些曲奇有一個最理想的**溫度區間**。

A strong figurative compound.

35. sweet spot — sport/equipment

= area on a bat, racket, club, etc. that produces the best contact/result

最佳擊球點；甜蜜點

Examples

1. The ball hit the racket's **sweet spot**.

球打中了球拍的**最佳擊球點**。

2. He struck the ball right on the **sweet spot**.

他正好打中球棒的**最佳擊球區**。

Sweet talk

36. sweet-talk

= use flattering or charming language to persuade someone

甜言蜜語地說服；哄

Examples

1. He **sweet-talked** them into giving him another chance.

他用**甜言蜜語哄得**他們再給他一次機會。

2. Don't try to **sweet-talk me**.

別想用**甜言蜜語哄我**。

Established compound verb.

37. sweet talk

= flattering or charming language used to influence someone

****甜言蜜語****

Examples

1. His ****sweet talk**** did not convince her.

他的****甜言蜜語****沒有說服她。

2. She saw through all the ****sweet talk****.

她看穿了那些****甜言蜜語****。

Sweetheart

38. sweetheart

A. romantic partner

****愛人；戀人****

1. They were childhood ****sweethearts****.

他們是青梅竹馬的****戀人****。

B. kind/lovable person

****可愛 / 貼心的人****

2. Thanks for helping—you're a ****sweetheart****.

謝謝你幫忙，你真是個****貼心的人****。

Lexicalized family member.

High-value expressions

39. short and sweet

= brief but pleasant, clear, or effective

****簡短精要；簡潔有力****

Examples

1. Keep the presentation ****short and sweet****.

把簡報保持得****簡短精要****。

2. His message was **short and sweet**.

他的訊息**簡短而到位**。

40. sweet dreams

= expression used when wishing someone a pleasant sleep

祝你好夢

Examples

1. Good night—**sweet dreams**.

晚安，**祝你好夢**。

2. She wished the children **sweet dreams**.

她祝孩子們**做個好夢**。

41. sweet smell/taste of success

= enjoyable satisfaction of success

成功的甜美滋味

Examples

1. After years of effort, they finally tasted the **sweetness of success**.

經過多年努力，他們終於嚐到了**成功的甜美滋味**。

2. Victory was made **sweeter** by the long struggle.

長久的奮鬥令勝利顯得更加**甘美 / 令人滿足**。

Key contrasts

42. sweet vs sugary

sweet

= tasting sweet

甜的

sugary

= containing a lot of sugar or strongly resembling sugar

****含糖量高的；甜膩的****

Something can taste sweet without containing sugar.

43. sweet vs savory

****sweet****

= sugar-like taste

****甜味的****

****savory / savoury****

= salty/spiced rather than sweet

****鹹香的；非甜味的****

Compare:

> sweet pastry

> 甜酥點

> savory pastry

> 鹹味酥點

44. sweet vs kind

****kind****

= caring and helpful

****善良的；友善的****

****sweet****

= can mean kind, but often sounds warmer, more affectionate, or endearing

****貼心的；可愛的****

Compare:

> She was kind to me.

> 她對我很好。

> That was sweet of her.

> 她那樣做真的很****貼心****。

45. sweet vs cute

****cute****

= attractive in a charming, often small/youthful way

****可愛的****

****sweet****

= may refer to appearance, but often includes affection, gentleness, or personality

****討人喜歡的；溫馨的****

46. sweeten vs add sugar

****add sugar****

= literal action only

****加糖****

****sweeten****

= broader: make something sweeter with sugar or another sweetener, and figuratively improve an offer/situation

Compare:

> sweeten the tea

> 把茶調甜

> sweeten the deal

> ****增加優惠令交易更吸引****

47. sweetener vs sugar

****sugar****

= one particular type of sweet substance

****糖****

****sweetener****

= any substance used to make something taste sweet

****甜味劑****

Sugar is a sweetener, but not every sweetener is sugar.

Meaning map

The central sensory concept is:

****pleasant sugar-like taste****

From this develop:

Food

sweet cake

→ ****甜的蛋糕****

Noun

a sweet

→ ****糖果****

Smell

sweet scent

→ ****芳香****

Sound

sweet voice

→ ****甜美聲音****

Personality

sweet person

→ ****親切可愛的人****

Affection

sweet message

→ ****甜蜜訊息****

Experience

sweet victory

→ ****令人滿足的勝利****

Passage

sweetness in life

→ **生活中的甜蜜、美好與溫馨**

The verb follows the idea of **adding sweetness**:

Literal

sweeten tea

→ **把茶調甜**

Figurative

sweeten the deal

→ **增加好處，令條件更吸引**

And the noun:

Literal

sweetener

→ **甜味劑**

Figurative

a financial sweetener

→ **額外誘因 / 加碼條件**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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sweet — taste	味道像糖、蜂蜜等；甜的
sweet — noun candy	英式英語常指糖果
sweets — confectionery	糖果 / 甜食
sweet — dessert	英式英語：餐後甜品
sweet — smell	氣味芳香、令人愉快的
sweet — sound/voice	聲音柔和、悅耳、甜美的
sweet — person/behavior	親切、溫柔、體貼、討人喜歡的
sweet of someone	某人的行為很貼心 / 體貼
sweet — romantic	充滿愛意、溫柔或浪漫的；甜蜜的
sweet — cute/charming	可愛、討人喜歡的
sweet — satisfying	令人特別愉快、滿足或痛快的
sweet! — informal	很棒！太好了！
sweet — technical low sulfur	石油等含硫量低的
sweetness — taste	食物 / 飲品的甜味或甜度

sweetness — personality	溫柔、親切、可愛的特質	
sweetness — figurative emotional	生活、關係或經歷中的甜蜜、溫馨與美好	
sweeten — taste	加入糖 / 甜味劑使食物或飲品變甜	
sweeten — become sweet	味道逐漸變甜	
sweeten an offer/deal	加入額外好處，使提議 / 交易更吸引	
sweeten a situation	使原本不理想的情況變得較愉快 / 較容易接受	
sweetened	已加入糖或其他甜味劑的	
unsweetened	沒有添加糖或甜味劑的	
sweetener — literal	用來增加甜味的糖或其他甜味劑	
artificial sweetener	非糖類的人工甜味劑 / 代糖	
natural sweetener	天然來源的甜味劑	
sweetener — figurative	為令交易 / 提議更吸引而加入的額外優惠 / 誘因	
sweetly	溫柔、甜美或悅耳地	
sweet tooth	很喜歡吃甜食；嗜甜	
sweet spot — optimum	最理想的程度、位置或平衡點	
sweet spot — sport	球拍、球棒等產生最佳擊球效果的位置	
sweet-talk — verb	用奉承、甜言蜜語說服某人	
sweet talk — noun	用來討好 / 說服人的甜言蜜語	
sweetheart — partner	愛人 / 戀人	
sweetheart — kind person	非正式：很可愛、很貼心的人	
short and sweet	簡短但清楚、有效或令人愉快的	

Passage recap

> “...a way to create comfort, celebration, and a little **sweetness in people’s lives**.”

Here:

****sweetness** = **warmth, happiness, tenderness, or pleasant moments that make life feel better****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****甜蜜**

* ****溫馨**

* ****美好**

* contextually: ****為生活增添一點甜蜜與幸福感****

Natural contextual translation:

****我也希望它能成為一種為別人帶來安慰、慶祝，以及為生活增添一點甜蜜與美好的方式。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****sweetness****

= ****a pleasant, warm, tender, or happy quality in life or an experience****

****甜蜜；溫馨；美好****

The key semantic progression is:

> ****sweet cake****

> → 味道甜

then:

> ****sweet person****

> → 親切、貼心

> ****sweet moment****

> → 溫馨甜蜜的時刻

and finally:

> ****sweetness in life****

> → ****生活中的幸福、美好與溫情****

The verb family follows the same metaphor:

> ****sweeten coffee****

> → 把咖啡調甜

but:

> ****sweeten the deal****

> → ****加入優惠，讓交易更吸引****

And:

> ****sweetener****

> → 甜味劑

but figuratively:

> ****a financial sweetener****

> → ****令條件更吸引人的額外優惠 / 誘因****

So the passage uses the fully figurative ****emotional-pleasantness**** branch of ****sweetness****, rather than literal sugariness.